
9TH EDITION · JAVASCRIPT RISING STARS

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

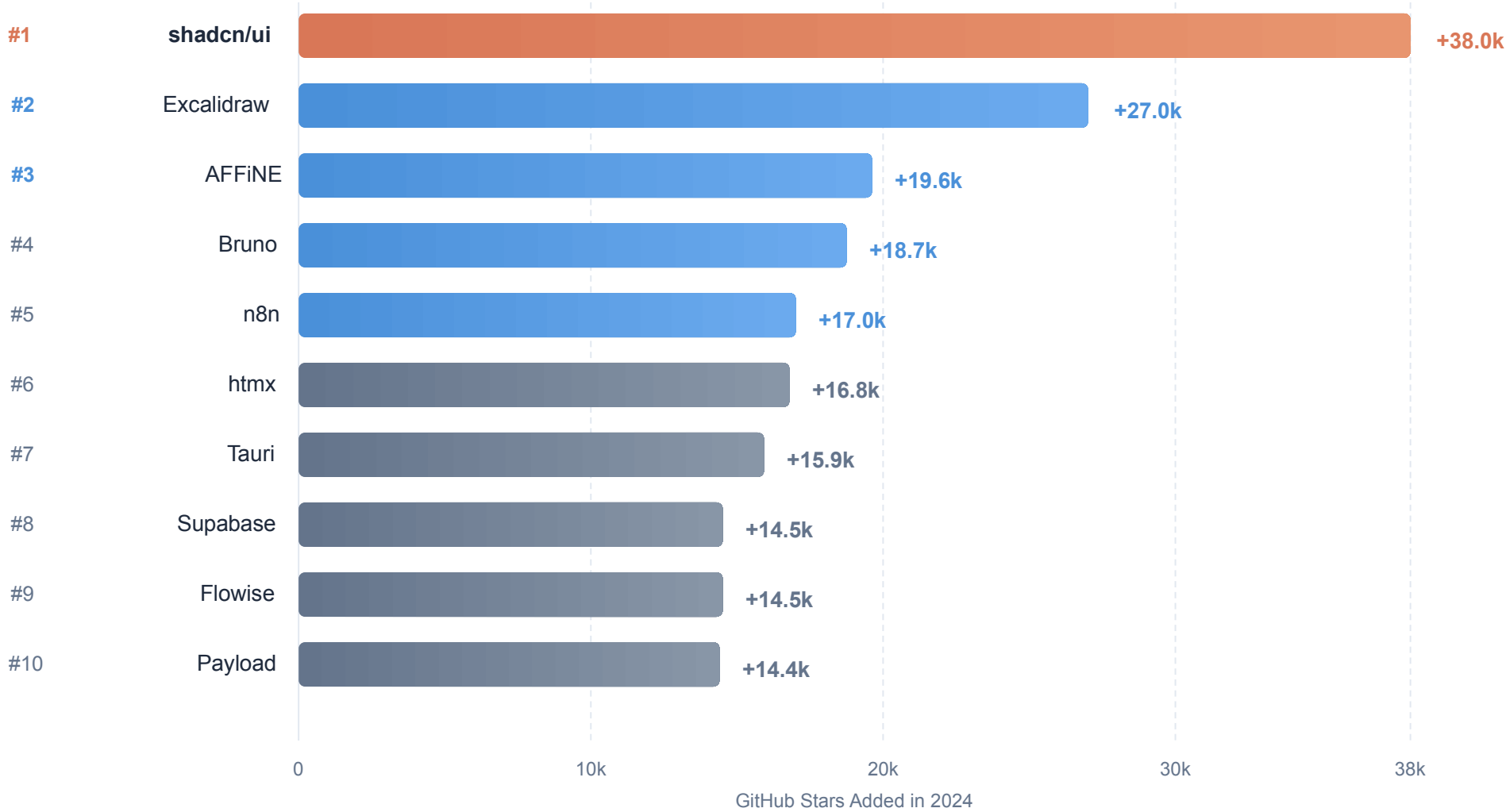
Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

The most-starred JavaScript projects of the year, ranked by GitHub stars added in 2024

Based on Best of JS curated project list

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE

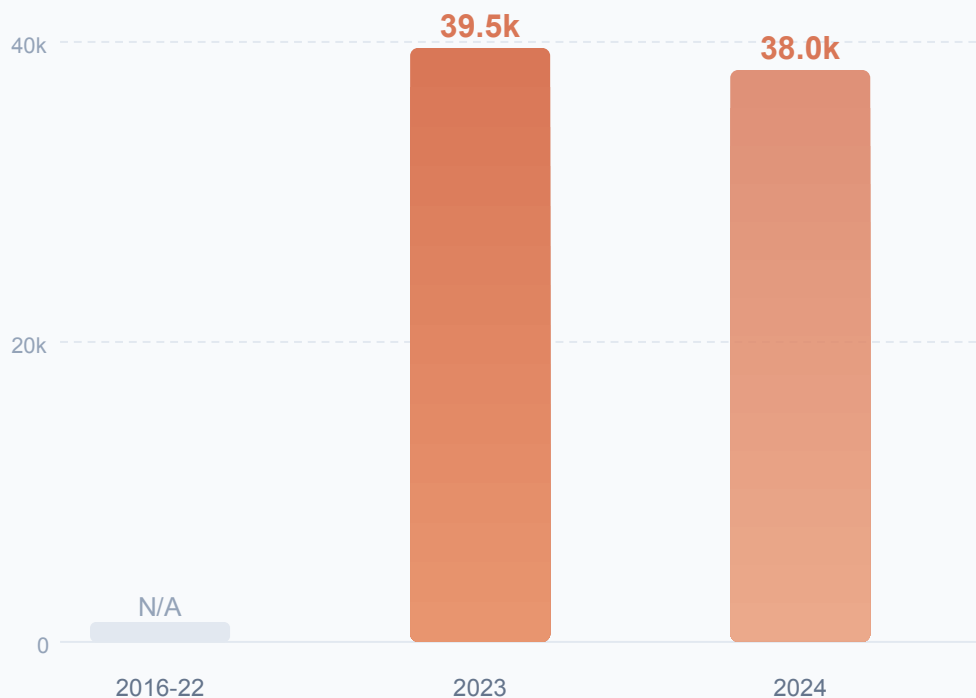
The #1 project gained 41% more stars than #2, demonstrating exceptional sustained momentum across 2024.



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Yearly Star Growth Trajectory

Total stars: 77.5k (created January 2023)



Only -4% YoY drop — extraordinary sustained momentum

Key 2024 Additions

Major features and ecosystem expansion



Charts

Powered by Recharts — built-in data viz



Themes

CSS variable generation for easy customization

Blocks

Layout collections for typical web applications

Responsive Sidebar

New responsive sidebar component



Upgraded CLI

Supports Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos
Install components, themes, hooks, utils, deps



Registry Ecosystem

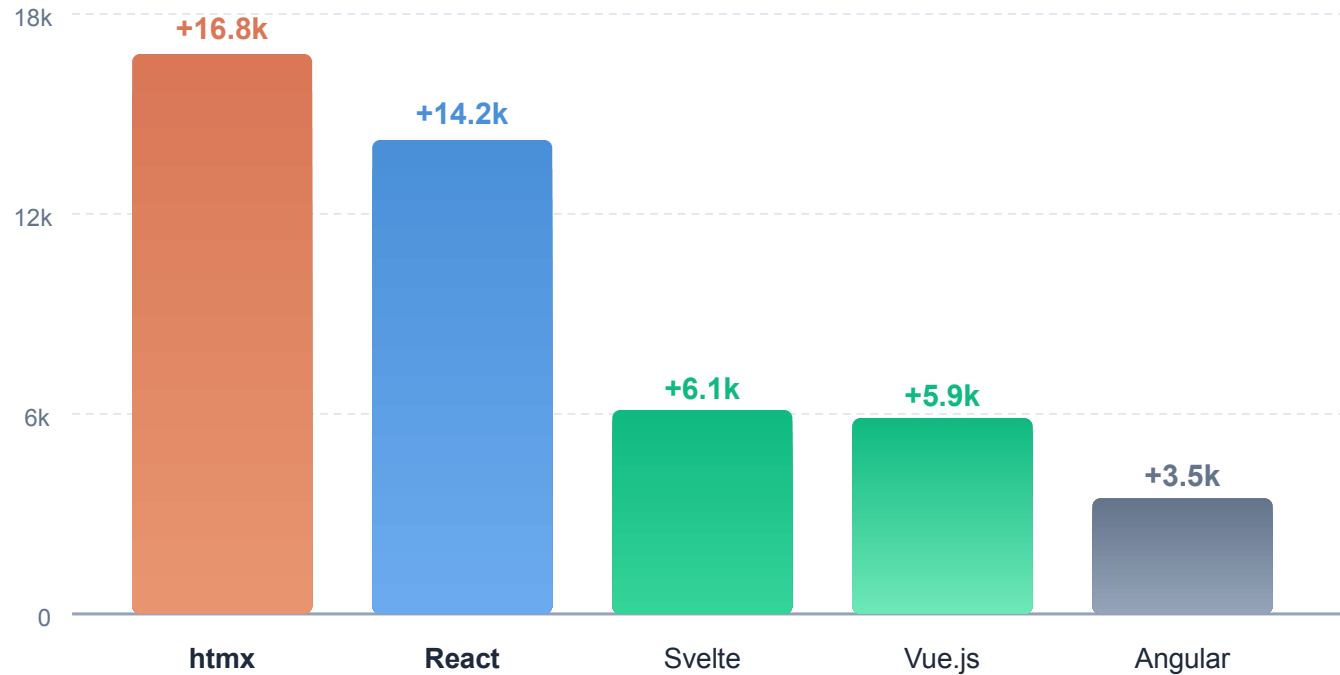
Derivative libraries: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI



v0 AI Integration

Vercel's AI-generated components boost adoption

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx: HTML-First Philosophy

Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX, WebSockets — no JavaScript required.

Rose from #2 (2023) to #1 (2024)

React 19: Three Years in the Making

Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements support, new hooks.

Evolving from library to framework specification

Svelte 5: Runes for Reactivity

Explicit reactive state declarations.

Highest positive opinion in State of JS survey

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

React is evolving from a standalone library into "a specification for frameworks" — Server Components redefine the boundary.

1	shadcn/ui Beautifully designed copy-paste components	+38.0k
2	Excalidraw Virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn diagrams	+27.0k
3	Payload Open-source fullstack Next.js framework	+14.4k
4	Magic UI shadcn/ui derivative — animated components	+13.2k
5	Next.js The React framework for the web	+12.1k



React 19's Server Components and Server Functions push React toward a "framework specification"

Multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix) now interpret React's primitives differently — a shift from library to specification

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

Vue 3.5's reactivity rework and a wave of high-quality UI libraries signal a confident, maturing ecosystem.



Vue 3.5 reworked reactivity with alien-signals — lighter, faster, already landed in main branch
The flourishing of Vue UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signals growing ecosystem confidence

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation Shape 2024



AI-Powered Tools

Workflow automation and LLM integration

n8n +17.0k

Fair-code workflow automation with native AI

Flowise +14.5k

Drag-and-drop UI for custom LLM flows

Supabase +14.5k

Open-source Firebase alternative

4 of top 10 have AI capabilities

AI integration is now table stakes



Desktop Apps

Web tech powering native experiences

Tauri +15.9k

Desktop and mobile apps with web frontend — Electron alternative

Key advantage: Smaller bundles, lower memory usage vs Electron

2024 milestone: Mobile support added — build for iOS and Android

#7 overall by stars added



Browser Innovation

Pushing the boundaries of what runs in-browser

PGlite

Full Postgres database running via WebAssembly — entirely in the browser

WebVM

A complete virtual machine running entirely in the browser

The browser is becoming a universal runtime

WASM enables capabilities previously limited to server-side environments

What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1

Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model won for the second year — 77.5k total stars prove developers want to own their UI code.

2

HTML-first is serious

htmx overtook React as #1 front-end framework by stars, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

3

React is becoming a framework specification

Server Components and Server Functions in React 19 mean frameworks interpret React's primitives differently.

4

AI integration is table stakes

Four of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

5

Vue's ecosystem maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing ecosystem.